📝 Notes

Nov 25, 2025

MLM Epic 1 Sprint Retrospective

Invited Prithwiraj Das Saleh Yasin methodjunction@gmail.com John Miranda Grace Lu Nirmith D'Almeida Fareen Khan Kanishka Deshpande Barbara Stevenson

Attachments MLM Epic 1 Sprint Retrospective

Meeting records Transcript

Summary

Method Junction led a sprint retrospective on Epic One MLM infrastructure, where the team agreed to continue weekly check-ins and set a "done dev deadline" to improve estimations, while suggesting that Barbara Stevenson finalize and clean up Figma designs before sprints to reduce rework. Participants also highlighted the need for better decision tracking, with Method Junction suggesting Confluence and Fareen Khan proposing Slack's canvas feature, as well as the importance of earlier product stakeholder involvement through visual demos, as suggested by Barbara Stevenson, to reduce testing time. The team discussed the difficulty of managing inter-team releases, with Method Junction proposing staggering releases and having a point of contact, possibly QA, to communicate with the release manager, Yuri.

Details

Notes Length: Standard

- **Sprint Retro Introduction and Setup** Method Junction initiated the sprint retrospective for Epic One MLM infrastructure, planning to follow the previous format of gathering input on "what went well" and "what to improve" and then

discussing action items. The team was given five minutes to add tickets under the appropriate categories (00:00:00).

- **What Went Well: Ticket Breakdown** The team identified that tickets were broken down well, which helped developers work in parallel (00:04:02). Method Junction inquired whether any additional considerations, beyond the minimal deployable unit, should be included in the breakdown process from a QA perspective, such as testing checklists (00:10:37).
- **Considerations for Ticket Breakdown** The team discussed whether it would be more beneficial to break down work horizontally (by workflow) or vertically (by transaction) for large screens with multiple new features, such as the new wedding inventory part (00:10:37). Method Junction suggested an action item to consider the implications of vertical or horizontal workflow breakdown from a testing or deployment perspective in future sprints (00:13:08).
- **Weekly Check-ins and Goal Setting** Method Junction noted that the team enjoyed the weekly spring check-in meetings and confirmed that they would continue (00:16:04). The team discussed setting a "done dev deadline" as a milestone they can control, since the release to production is often out of the team's hands (00:17:09) (00:19:14). Method Junction created a done dev tracker, and the team suggested estimating based on this milestone to improve estimations (00:18:09).
- **To Improve: Figma and Design Alignment** The development team requested breaking down Figma designs to only include elements for the current sprint to avoid confusion and rework. Method Junction acknowledged that this would reduce potential defects and suggested that Barbara Stevenson, the designer, should clean up and finalize the designs before the sprint starts, or at least dedicate more time to review (00:22:00) (00:27:26). The team also discussed making Figma non-editable to prevent accidental changes once the designs are finalized (00:24:05).
- **To Improve: Documentation and Decision Tracking** The team identified a need for a better way to document decisions, as critical conversations about flows and triggers were often only communicated verbally, leading to confusion during testing (00:34:14). Method Junction suggested using Confluence as a centralized repository for documentation, while Fareen Khan proposed using Slack's canvas feature for immediate decision logging before transferring to Confluence (00:35:28).

- **To Improve: Early Involvement and Proactive Demos** Method Junction highlighted the need to involve product stakeholders earlier, especially for screens that have been created, to ensure alignment with Figma designs and catch defects sooner (00:38:00). Barbara Stevenson suggested incorporating visual demos, even if the feature is not fully fleshed out, during the weekly sprint check-ins to gain early feedback and reduce testing time at the end of the sprint (00:39:15).
- **To Improve: Avoiding Experimental Tools and Technical Errors** The team agreed that experimental tools and new approaches, such as the Nicholas tool or using App Publisher for migrations, should be tested outside of the sprint to prevent failures and blockages (00:40:18). Method Junction also brought up the issue of errors only being caught in production, not on any other environments, and suggested that while there's no immediate solution, the team should continue to check app publish functionality after deployment to catch issues (00:41:40) (00:43:46).
- **Need for More Retrospectives and Structured Meetings** A team member noted that there was a lack of time and space to communicate feedback during the sprint and that the team needed more frequent retrospectives (00:47:47). Method Junction agreed to explore bi-weekly retros, which is the minimum standard, and proposed that weekly check-ins should include time for capturing feedback to share in the retro (00:48:48). The team also raised concerns about meetings lacking strict, agenda-oriented structure and running over time, especially the focus on missing deadlines during check-ins (00:52:57).
- **Emphasis on Deadlines vs. Quality** Method Junction acknowledged the perception from leadership that the team is missing deadlines, and discussed the need to justify these misses, particularly when the issues are out of the team's control, such as deployment and release processes (00:55:49) (00:59:00). The team agreed that quality should be the higher priority and that the check-in meetings should be structured and time-boxed to avoid spending too much time justifying deadlines (00:54:24) (00:56:56).
- **Addressing Perception and Delivery** Method Junction noted that historical perspective may not assist with the current situation, but acknowledged that leadership, including Ben, has a perception that can only be countered by delivering good quality work. They stated that the team does not have a direct avenue to justify their work to management, citing John as someone who feels their hands are tied regarding deadlines and priorities, especially when

considering the time spent resolving release issues versus developing new features. Method Junction also highlighted an issue where the team was assigned the migration service as a ticket, which was not initially owned by them, and had to fix it mid-sprint, causing difficulty, especially since the component is used by other teams (00:59:57).

- **Inter-Team Communication and Release Management** Method Junction expressed the difficulty of managing multiple teams pushing out new work simultaneously, suggesting staggering releases or ensuring not all teams are on a sprint at the same time (01:01:28). They proposed that each team needs a point of contact to communicate with the release manager or other teams to coordinate release schedules (01:02:45). Currently, Yuri is managing the release queue, but previously, the team had to coordinate manually to ask about the number of apps or screens being released (01:03:50).
- **Role of QA in Cross-Team Communication** Method Junction discussed whether QA or a developer should communicate release timelines to Yuri, the release manager. They suggested that it is more convenient for QA to communicate since QAs are already embedded in different teams, providing a natural communication channel (01:03:50). However, Method Junction emphasized that the main issue is not the communication itself but how soon in advance they need to start communicating outside their team, as defect cycles make it difficult to estimate completion dates confidently (01:05:20).
- **Release Queue and Bug Prioritization** A concern was raised regarding the current release queue for stock apps, which prioritizes sprint items, making it difficult to release P2 bugs promptly, citing the purchase order ticket as an example (01:05:20). Method Junction confirmed they would create a document and share it to address action items, starting immediately with decision blog documentation. They also plan to set up bi-weekly sprint retro meetings and weekly check-in meetings, ensuring all meetings are structured and time-boxed (01:06:26).
- **Decision Meetings Structure** Method Junction suggested that meetings for discussing decisions should be separate from the existing weekly group, primarily because the development resources are split between Kanban and Sprint work (01:06:26). They opted for keeping the decision discussions weekly, initially creating a 30-minute decision model to manage the process efficiently, and noted that they would find a workable time for these meetings. The meeting concluded with thanks to K and Barbara (01:07:49).

Suggested next steps

- [ ] Method Junction will ensure that the documentation stays aligned with what is currently happening moving forward.
- [ ] Method Junction will create a decision log on Slack and try it out with the current sprints and Confluence to see the impact.
- [ ] The group will have bi-weekly sprint retrospectives, as it is the company minimum.
- [ ] Method Junction will consider the implications of vertical or horizontal workflow breakdown from a testing and deployment perspective in future sprints.
- [ ] Method Junction will make the weekly check-in meeting open and required for everyone to attend to ensure everyone is up to date.
- [ ] Method Junction will set up bi-weekly sprint retro meetings, weekly check-in meetings, and a 30-minute weekly decision model meeting.
- [ ] Method Junction will create a doc, post it on Confluence, and share it with the team to review the action items.
- [ ] Method Junction will start immediately with the decision blog action items.
- [ ] Method Junction will ensure that all meetings are structured and time-boxed.
- [ ] Method Junction will put an actual time box for decision meetings.

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00:00:00

Barbara Stevenson: All right, Laura. Thank you.
Method Junction: I was based on index dynamics and power was the hard what's up guys and that same thing works on other or it's not working on other uh
Barbara Stevenson: that one. That's if we just pass it back. Why you want to put it?
Method Junction: account your your own account but if you change account to any other accounts on metadata and try to test it out there.
Barbara Stevenson: Huh? Yeah. As opposed to that one.
Method Junction: I think maybe tested on a couple of beta accounts.
Barbara Stevenson: So cancel.
Method Junction: Okay, I'll look at other data.
Barbara Stevenson: Is that over there? Okay.
Method Junction: All right, guys. We're going to do a sprint retro for our Epic One MLM infrastructure sprint. Um, similar to how we did it before, I'll show you this link. I'll set a time um maybe five minutes and people just add in uh a ticket for each what went well, what to improve and then we can do action items together and then justever I gave each person 50

00:02:21

Barbara Stevenson: Oh s***.
Method Junction: so I'll go off. It's one person.
Barbara Stevenson: I'm just
Method Junction: Okay, let me share it. I'll put it in the chat. pages. Yeah, I don't want to put it on our slack.
Barbara Stevenson: I should Hello.
Method Junction: What? Okay, then I'll just put in the slack. Delete that after. Okay. Okay.
Barbara Stevenson: Do you have the code? Huh? Do you have Hello.

Method Junction: Is everyone? Yeah. Okay. I'm gonna put a timer. Give me one sec. Five minutes. I think five minutes timer.
Barbara Stevenson: Yes. Yeah. Just follow the map.
Method Junction: Can I do it afterwards?
Barbara Stevenson: Okay.
Method Junction: Um your tickets after you want to add.
Barbara Stevenson: All right. Thank you.
Method Junction: Yeah. How long your automation take? Okay. Yeah, sure. It's fine. If anything, you just call out what you want to say.

00:04:02

Barbara Stevenson: What's up?
Method Junction: But obviously five minutes again. Okay. Walk. All right. Anyone doing any last minute ads? Are we good to discuss? Okay. Let me know. Cool. Okay, let me just uh sort this by so we can discuss. Okay, so what went well? Uh tickets were broken down well, making it easier for devs to work in parallel. Um uh I think that's the only reference to breaking down oh ticket breakdown help us work in parallel which helped a lot. Um anything else anyone wanted to ask um talk more about for this specific one or we can obviously continue doing this making sure we're breaking down these tickets better on future sprints but it seems like that's something that we're doing really well as a team and spending and investing in that time before we start. Yeah. Uh one thing that I did want to ask uh is from a QA perspective uh is there anything else that could be done in the breakdown itself.

00:10:37

Method Junction: So we try to break it down based on the minimal deployable unit. But uh should should we be considering anything additional when breaking down from QA perspective as in instead of just having it as a deployable unit? Uh is there anything additional as a checklist for uh testing rather than just a deployment? Good question. I think the um stock app stuff per screen for the most part was fine except for the new wedding inventory part. That one was a lot. I think at some point both and were working on it at the same time or maybe not like actually at the same time, but I gave you both things to fix on that one screen. And even when both the devs were working on the

same screen, we did not have issues deploying or pushing those changes, right? There were a few changes that uh that kind of got over overlapped. Which one? The next script. Yeah. Yeah. That's not deployed, is it? It's not deployed yet.

00:11:59

Method Junction: No, but it's from a testing standpoint. There was significantly more testing on that one screen to the other. Yeah. Okay. Like to the point Yeah. where like I did more defects for both of you to work on at the same time. So where this is coming from is then in that case would it be easier to have it broken down as a horizontal uh as a workflow or as a transaction vertical. I think specifically for that ticket, it probably would have been better to break it down as a workflow because what Fine was working on was more I think a lot of the stuff was the stock adjustment that was available on that screen whereas what Nurmouth was working on was like design stuff, location stuff sort of. So, but yeah, that that only applies because the the one screen is so large and has multiple new features that we're adding to it. Russia and uh just to confirm yeah from testing perspective it is still CTA oriented right vertical versus horizontal. Yeah.

00:13:08

Method Junction: Uh oh. But in that case uh any testing that could happen before a CPA comes into picture or no as in we do deploy something in the background uh let's say a migration that goes out and has some data structures but those data structures don't need to be specifically tested right. Oh like in terms of the stock apps. Yeah. Well, I wasn't able to test it before. I think the issue that we saw while p pushing the stock app update to prod was actually the same one that I saw the first time I published it. Okay. Like when I had to force them on the stock table. Okay. So I think an action item here is like consider implications of vertical or horizontal workflow breakdown from a testing and deployment perspective like in future sprints or yes and kind of you'll have to decide at that particular time would be a deployable or a testable perspective. So instead of a slash probably make it more like or deployable or deploy deployable.

00:14:31

Method Junction: deployable perspective. Okay. Because it seems like uh from a dev perspective deployable seems to be easier to break down and work. Mh. Uh so that pretty and at that point and both of those would be able to work on separate things. Mh. But then there would be some workflows that kind of are horizontally broken down, right? Yes, a button that needs to be developed and the workflow based on that button whereas other de is working on the grid same page. Mhm. So probably yeah that's a decision probably we'll have to make for upcoming events. Okay. All right. Um we'll move on. Consistent communication of problems and impact on our deadlines. Um yeah, I think team did really well here, especially the devs just communicating progress, problems, impacts, as well as from a QA standpoint, what's happening with deploying, testing, and the releasing. So nothing to report on there. We just continue doing that. Uh so just continue. Um okay.

00:16:04

Method Junction: Um the team enjoy the weekly spring check-in meetings. Yeah. You guys want to continue doing that? Was the frequency good? I guess it was fine. Uh we don't have a couple of to improve things that help can be added into Okay. Okay. Um okay. Oh yeah, this is mine. Uh I said I personally believe we set a realistic sprint completion date, but due to factors out of our control, we missed it. Um, I guess that's kind of in line with we're based on our previous sprint, we're actually um learning on how to estimate correctly and provide realistic uh deadlines. Um, unfortunately, we missed this sprint one, but hopefully for the next one. Um, we continue learning and improve on that. So, um, uh, just just a question on that the how do we improve on the things that were out of our hands? Yeah. Yeah, that that's a point. We can't improve on that, but we can continue improving on setting realistic goals.

00:17:09

Method Junction: Okay. Yeah. So, a suggestion was and this came up when I was talking to Rich as well. Yeah. Um we could aim for a done dev deadline. Done dev deadline. Yeah. Not that many checkpoints. Uh no, as in that ticket will be in done dev column. M we do not know when it will get released just because of the release part is

out of our team's hands. Mhm. But at least we can aim for that ticket to be in the done dev column until a certain time. Yeah. After that it's a part of communicating with multiple teams. Yeah. And that's where uh one of our one of the team members would have to communicate with the business manager to get those sorted out. Yeah. and kind of follow up on when can we acquire our teams. That makes sense. Yeah. Yeah. That's what uh you built, right? That's the done dev tracker, right?

00:18:09

Method Junction: Or are you talking about it from uh that's okay. So, uh what I develop is manual updates. What I plan on building is what we're discussing right now. Yeah. But what you built also? Um, it's just not between you and now that's you though. It's only done though. Right. We're aiming for a done dev on an expected date. Something similar. Yes. And at least that is something that we could try to check. Mhm. Uh just so that if you want to really improve on estimations, we could estimate based on that. Yeah. Apart from that if test or QA wants their uh estimations to be as best possible. Yeah, I know for the previous sprit I did create that um Excel sheet but I don't know if dev team populated it. I shared it with the team. It was similar to this done dev like how many days expected it to take versus actual completion date but uh I guess we didn't really do that but it's okay.

00:19:14

Method Junction: we'll do moving forwards but okay uh aim for dev um I say checkpoints or um milestones so the milestones we are looking at done dev only right the excel sheet that created is just end date as in done dev yeah that's done dev that is not the expected end date is It's not not production, right? Yeah. Yeah. That's not production. It's just I think because it those being on production is out of our control like you mentioned. We want to track against what we can control, right? So aim for dev um milestone do um let's just say that estimate according to okay uh but that would just be that wouldn't be for our spring completion deadline though this would just be something we internally we track against correct and that is for development perspectives specifically um I guess if that helps then we can at least compare like when how long release will take like you know from in test to release when it gets released before compared to like different we can have like a difference if you can kind of averaging out

there I guess so okay averaging is very uh tricky when it comes to things that are out of our hands because we do every time there could be a different reason why the is gets held up.

00:20:55

Method Junction: This last time it was migration now we fixed migration. Tomorrow there will be stock apps block up then they'll ask us to fix stock apps then we will fix stock apps and then something else comes up. So it's I don't know if that is specifically we could use it for it's some data that is there in the background. If we decide to kind of focus that data into or channelize that data into that, we could. But if not, it's just that we at least try to look at gundev column and improve ourselves. Good feedback. Uh we'll do that. Um straightforward onboarding. That's great. Yeah. Amazing man. It's easy for me to I feel like I had support enough to just walk into the team and start working. Amazing. That went good. Awesome. Okay. And uh that's the same thing. Take a breakdown. Okay. So to improve, we got a couple of stuff here. So uh break Figma down for the actual sprint and don't have things we need to implement.

00:22:00

Method Junction: I know what you guys are referring to, but dev team speak you can just speak more about it. Yeah. Uh so I guess like uh I can if I can finish as well as when we were building on some of the screens we kind of noticed that after we discussing with you were like well some of these screens are not supposed to be built this even though they were all sharing the same sections which was I guess like a little confusing because we built up the screens and then we just spent a couple of minutes I'm going to say like an hour uh looking at those screens seeing what flows we can possibly implement and then we reach out to John we just found out like oh we don't have to tell that and then just push the stickers forward. It's nothing beyond it that much, but I guess like breaking down what we intend like what screens we intend from those sections to be released that sprint would definitely help us out with that's what it is. Would it would be helpful that just before we start sprint uh we add one more ticket for probably Barbara or anyone else to just clean up the Figma and finalize the designs.

00:23:03

Method Junction: That's exactly what we'll be deploying. Everything that is there will be deployed. Yeah, I I see I see that point. It also will reduce the amount of potential issues like for example potential defects that can be created down the line because by then we will come to know like oh this is not available we don't have that we don't have this and we can just be limited to what we do have and then I think it applies to the epic as well but there were some requirements that were outdated. Oh that is true. uh although in that case okay so I can understand from an epic perspective this can change but for a sprint perspective this should never change the epic it got discovered after as well right so initially nothing changed we initially thought that uh the quantities will change when we have an invoice or a bill created but then we changed it to a partial fulfillment workflow within sales orders itself so we have to get rid of we want to get rid off a few triggers that we already added a few infrastructure.

00:24:05

Method Junction: I think this has to do with the triggers. What's that? It's not the triggers like we don't do for the warehouses. It's like one specific feature request that was moved to Epic 2. I remember you remember which one? It's like one of the earliest ones. I don't I don't remember. Um maybe it's the legal name one or it's related to designs and the PRD, right? Or that thing. Yes. Okay, maybe you can get back to me and but I I see your POV. Um but yeah, some of some of those things uh definitely could have been um updated uh asynchronously uh to ensure that everything's aligned, but um yeah, I'll just make a note for that. Also, is there a way to lock Figma? because sometimes when I'm trying to go through I end up moving something I don't want to and by you're in that mode right no like when I when I do go through it sometimes if I click I could
Barbara Stevenson: something. Oh s***.

00:25:14

Barbara Stevenson: Oh, I feel like if you do, just leave leave a comment cuz sometimes I get confused because there's so many moving parts and changing things.
Method Junction: drag it so that's what I'm Once we get those Figma designs, those

shouldn't be changeable at that point.
Barbara Stevenson: So if that happens, just leave a comment. It's fine. I'll revert it.
Method Junction: Just make screenshots out of it or something. Uh, that's fine with me. But it's just that make it noneditable or something or give us don't give us access to change in the first place. Something like that. That was the validation, right? Sure, but on the warehouse like the items app that's a validation about global unique. Yeah, but it's in the topic. Yes. No, I know we I moved those on to epic number two. But yeah, I I you're talking about it from a testing standpoint. I'm testing from a like talking about a scope standpoint. It's in the epic, but we didn't do it.

00:26:22

Method Junction: The documentation should be updated. Mhm. But we also scoped for that and then we realized we didn't we we weren't planning to do that anyways in the in the current in the current spring. So then why wasn't it removed? Why wasn't it removed from the epic? Yeah. Um I must have not removed it. That's the only reason. Yeah. Um yeah, that that's on me. Although although as we go about I think uh we spoke to Ben about this long time ago as well that Ben mentioned it's like riding a bus while building it right. Yeah. So as we discover things there is going to be some some gap in where uh hey we thought this was going to be in this first row itself but no we will be doing that in the second row because it better aligns with how we can structure and deploy something or how we can push something for sure some things like you plan for but they don't happen but I'd say responsibility to ensure the document still stays aligned with what's currently happening.

00:27:26

Method Junction: So, moving forward, I'll I'll ensure that. Um, uh, but regarding your comment about having Barbara review the designs to make sure everything's, um, you know, nothing's going to be changing at that point in time when we start the sprint. Um, I I'm pretty sure Barbara already does that. Or Barbara, you have any comments? Is that something you want to have a ticket to do that before a sprint starts or Yeah.
Barbara Stevenson: I don't know. I feel like I already do that. We just had too many moving parts this last time. So, yeah. I If we want to do a ticket to make it to log it officially for the team, that's fine. But I already do that.

Method Junction: Yeah. I I think this is more of a uh we just improved and Barbara is also aware that the designs that she's making is for the current spring and I'm also reviewing them with her. So, um, we'll just, uh, add more time on RSI to ensure everything's prepared and ready to go.

00:28:22

Method Junction: So, basically, the reason I brought this up was, um, we go in and we just feed the uh, Pigma to AI. Yeah. Now, if AI spits out something and you directly copy and paste it, Yeah. Uh, we do not want changes saying, "Hey, we not we do not want this, we do not want that." Yeah. Yeah, that's where I am coming from. This that that's the thought process. If we can implement that great. Mhm. And this will be good even better when no code completes their changes. Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. So they are working on something AI oriented itself. Right. That's true. So if we are able to set that process right now, we would be just feeding images and AI would be directly designing our streets. That's what probably will help for if you have anything else like or Yeah.
Fareen Khan: Uh, not really. It was just mainly that last time we had like a bunch of screens that we weren't building, but like this time it's based off the FR, so it should be fine this time around.

00:29:36

Fareen Khan: Um, and like obviously there's going to be like stuff we find out during the sprint, which we can hop on afterwards, but it was like I don't know. The last sprint had a bunch of screens we weren't actually building. It was just m to show the flow, but like I don't think maybe a comment would have helped. I I don't know. That's just what I'm thinking because we thought we were going to build it, but um we ended up so like on the I forget which screen
Barbara Stevenson: When you say comment, you make comment on the design that this it's not for the it it's not for the sprint or you don't think the flow I don't really get that part.
Fareen Khan: it was. One of the screens we weren't like fully building out. I think it's the items list thing. We weren't fully building out. It was like most of it built out, but um there was uh a comment like, "Oh, maybe we're not fully building this out this sprint. Maybe something like that might have helped." But

00:30:35

Fareen Khan: now that it's based off of um FRS, I don't think that issue should be should be there anymore to be honest. I think now it's a lot more clear the flows
Barbara Stevenson: Yeah, but yeah, I think what makes what you said also makes sense. So perhaps in future if there's like a page that's not being fully built out, we could just spell out what exactly is not being fully built out there.
Method Junction: And also so do we where do we land on creating a ticket or not to kind of finalize and uh if we want that or not just Because okay so for even for another example what Grace mentioned for validation yeah if that validation model popup is in this pigma itself you would definitely build that in yeah yeah but if not then it's like oh we do we uh refer the uh FR or PRV or do we just refer the Pigma designs did something change something like that I think with the with the nature of the upcoming sprints. Barbara literally created each FAR based on the PRD.

00:31:47

Method Junction: So, um I don't know if that's a process we should be implementing, having us a sprint ticket just for barber to, you know, go in and ensure the designs are, you know, identical or exactly as is because she spent countless amount of hours actually creating every single screen there. So, um, it's going to be a lot more work for her to just, you know, go in and make sure everything's updated. I think she already did her due diligence here. So, um, considering this is feedback that we already received and, um, up to up to you if that's something you want to do. I think from my perspective, the designs are solid, but up to you.
Barbara Stevenson: So he's saying I should create a ticket to ensure that I'm designing it according to the FR.
Method Junction: No, as in like you mentioned. So, so the thing is those designs uh if they were uh created on November 1st and now that it's November 25th, that's when we are picking things up. Um there could be some changes or some iterations that came in from product perspective that we want this as well or this is the header that we want to change something similar.

00:33:02

Method Junction: Uh is there a requirement for a ticket just before we pick up the sprint to ensure all of the Figma designs are as expected to product?
Barbara Stevenson: There isn't a ticket, but if you would like for us to have a ticket officially for that, I I would look into it, but I feel like I already break it down. So, those changes, if we add a header, it could be comments Figma. Uh if like I guess I'd experiment with that, but I don't at this time I'm not really sure how to address it.
Method Junction: I think I I think the consensus is like um she's already done her due diligence here with the with the designs and um if anything I I can even go into it just to make sure major that everything's aligned with it and if anything is not we add comments like that's how me and Barbara have been communicating about it to ensure literally everything is up to date and matching with the F. So um if we'll see how the sprint goes with it but I'm almost confident that everything in the designs are what's being built here.

00:34:14

Method Junction: Okay, cool. Um let's go to the next one. Need a better way to document decisions. Um what's this about? Oh. Um, so we had a bunch of conversations going left and right about the flows and everything. Yeah. So I guess that's what it was and then a couple things were changed based on those flows and then when Grace was testing it was based on uh for example triggers and everything. We did change a couple things within triggers. But that was just more verbatim than actually documented. So when Grace was verifying it and she was like this shouldn't be working this way. But then we had like meetings on meetings on meetings to explain why it is working this way. So I guess it is better to actually have a track some at least something we can write down somewhere going live we have this conversation I guess we can take inspiration from um Kevin's team the growth team so they have like their own section in slack where they document all the decisions and what happened in the meetings and we can probably use it over that to at least track what we basically said doing for those that's what I basically wrote that ticket about that comment about yeah the only reason and onboarding was so smooth was yeah you guys helped a lot but majority was just documentation I don't have to wait on self explain something

00:35:28

Method Junction: I could just like pop up once and just read the documentation uh the documentation still say conference or uh I I for conference because we're moving everything to conference regard it's central updates Yes, we were discussing this. We wrote this in a Google talk about it, right? What do you think is best? Like because we currently have all of our conversations in in our meetings going to emails and since we get a ton of emails going like latest errors, data log issues and then service time it kind of gets buried like one email will be even if you had a meeting yesterday it would get buried among 50 different emails, right? So then another conversation will be today which is like a little difficult to track. So I guess confidence maybe might maybe at least we'll be able to as long as we can break it down by team voice you know restrict people from doing it. Yeah I feel like every decision that's made like put upload it into confluence so we keep track right and if there's a Google meet link also provide that reference so you can easily you know reference anything.

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Fareen Khan: So new.
Method Junction: Yeah I guess that would also help you out with your effect so you know any changes we make then I can just go in and update accordingly.
Fareen Khan: You could also use um Slack. So um what Nermat mentioned like team growth, they have a bunch of tabs at the top and basically you can create like a a doc like a canvas where you could log decisions. So if we want to like break it up into sprint decisions, if they're conversations or just DMs or however the decision decisions are made, we can add them to the Slack channel and then update the confluence based off that because um this morning um I created another like useful links which is kind of what I'm I was thinking thinking we're going to use for a decision might be
Method Junction: We're talking about the grooming one. So if you go and click on that scroll composition
Fareen Khan: good. It's basically just a Confluence doc just on Slack and then we can just copy paste it on Confluence.
Method Junction: So you're saying basically do something similar to uh grow team with this uh slack uh weekly grooming but instead it's like decision logs and we just anything that's populated from here we just transfer over to confluence.

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Method Junction: Yeah.
Fareen Khan: Yeah, because I think um because I think like if the it's like a lot more easy access for most of us than to open up Confluence, we could just go to Slack, see what the decision was made on XYZ date. Um and then if you want to make those decisions public, then we can post it to I mean they they'll be quote unquote public because anyone can go into the team channel.
Method Junction: Yeah, sure.
Fareen Khan: But um we can have it on confluence as well as like I don't know a sync or like just have it there as well.
Method Junction: Yeah, I can uh I can create one. Now we can try it out with this um the springs and then also with confluence and see um the impact of this. Try it out. Okay. Um okay. Uh involve Yeah. Okay. So this one was involve product early launch review align on design reviews cach defects early. Um yeah this is just based on um dev was all completed all the screens were completed and then I think the week one week it was just uh right right before like I guess testing uh or when uh Grace started testing she was catching a bunch of defects and then a product also reviewed it and we caught more defects.

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Method Junction: So I think whenever there are any screens that have been created, just involve a product early and make sure that it's aligned with the Figma designs. And if there is a work around that you guys created, just make sure we're aligned on that. Nothing more than that. Um, product proactive demos during sprint check-in to catch any design defects early. I guess that's the same thing. Yeah, I don't know who put that, but I think so. Yeah. Yeah.
Barbara Stevenson: Sorry, that's me. Sorry, there's some background noise, but for me, um towards the tail end of our sprint checking, I think we're doing that weekly. Um maybe what I'm thinking or rather suggesting is I don't know how long our sprint would be, but um when we have something even if it's not fleshed out fully, so it's easier for us to say, "Oh, how's move this, let's do it this Cuz I feel like at the end where Grace when Grace and I were queuing, it kind of took some more time. I mean, that's still going to happen, but we could just have, yeah, this is where I'm at.

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Barbara Stevenson: Cuz you're already saying where you're at. But a visual will be helpful as well.
Method Junction: Um, avoid experimental tools. Trying new ways during sprint should be done separate to the sprint to avoid failures. Is this related to us experimenting with the Nicholas tool?
Fareen Khan: Yeah. So I put this there because um underneath stock apps changes there is a section that says we can do migrations with like app publisher by putting the field which is what we tried to do this time around but then in hindsight we probably should have done that outside of the sprint made sure it worked and made like to avoid that first failure. So, um, yeah, that's basically saying like if there's something we want to try out, just don't do it during a sprint and like make sure it works properly before actually using it within the sprint.
Method Junction: Okay. Okay, good feedback. Uh, documentation on some tools. Is this related to the on decisions? Any comments here?
Fareen Khan: Uh that's just for migrations and um a couple of those things migration has decent documentation.

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Fareen Khan: There are a couple things miss missing um on it. So we should probably update whatever we find like not gatekeep any any info.
Method Junction: need to communicate change decisions made with sprint. Okay, that's the same with talking decisions. Uh better communication between releases and exact scenario replication since some errors were only caught on production and not in any environments. Yeah, I wrote that one. Um I can explain. Uh so what happened is like when we tried pushing up all the screens uh we got the um what's it missing section location name but only happened on pod not on any of the other environments. I don't think this can actually be done by any of us right now. But if we can I guess replicate the exact environments that were causing this, we can probably catch it much earlier on, right? This we kind of just push all the screen. We wanted to push all the screens and technically would have worked if we ran it the second time, but we didn't want to deal with 10,000 errors at like one given at every single release because that was to stop it from happening regularly, right?

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Method Junction: So that's why I kind of just thought one was this. So how would we action this
Fareen Khan: Um I think the error was it was an inconsistent error on some accounts. So I think there's like one or two maybe on warehouse but since there was only one or two it was kind of like it was just drowned out in all the other log messages and it was hard to see cuz I remember um I think it was Yuri or someone who sent a message that it did happen on warehouse but he found it after like searching for the actual error message on that day.
Method Junction: Yeah, it was in a different release as well. That was the thing on Monday as compared to the Friday release, right? So, Friday staging.
Fareen Khan: Yeah.
Method Junction: So, it wouldn't have been caught by us either way. So I guess like if someone finds something but clean it out probably it's like a after you deploy we just confirm app publish also works again like that's some like an example so publish some other changes again and

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Fareen Khan: Yeah.
Method Junction: then check if uh we have anything in block maybe that could app. Right now, there's like no real solution for this that we can action on. So, it's just probably like a shot in the dark, but I just wanted to bring it up cuz it caused a lot of headache for Yuri and then for us as well and I don't want that to happen again. So, better to deal with it now. I mean, for this point, I don't think we have any screen app releases per se other than just validations, right? Uh yeah, and we do have a few screen releases. Yes. Yeah. then we we got to be careful. Um but we I don't think apart from locations and a few other screens we are not adding any fields specifically. So the back back end wouldn't be that stressed. It's it would be more on the UI and directly on the C#. That's it.
Fareen Khan: Also, uh this time around we're using migrations, right?

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Fareen Khan: We're not using app publisher. So, if even if we do find any fields we need to add, that'll just be done via migration.
Method Junction: Yeah. Uh and also in the first ticket or second ticket itself we are checking we are checking by putting all of this fields on the screen and hitting app publish. check which uh fields it's creating in the background and just put all of those fields in the migration so that it does not differ from what I published simply. So um how do you want me to write this action item? Uh so but this is like a very technical action item. It's not a process oriented action item. This was like a particular scenario that we had to we learn from process wise probably I know also brought it up but in that case what do we not trust anything any documentation like that's very difficult to kind of navigate uh as in trying out new things I thought that documentation was pretty solid until we actually had to use it and then uh we found out issues.

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Method Junction: Uh probably going back and updating the document saying hey we tried to use this in this scenario and we had some issues but that's about it. It would have to be on a scenario's perspective, right? Okay. So, continue sharing learnings with other teams that do not that have uh that work under some terms and conditions. Okay. All right. I think we're almost done. Um, align acceptance criteria with design flows that there's less we work. Um, yeah, I think that's related to the PRD being changed with those decisions and the designs um, not maybe not reflecting it. So yeah, I've caught that already here. And then breakdown designs show what is workable. Okay, so we already talked about that too. Um, cool. Is there anything else uh we're missing here or anything else anyone wanted to share? That's more retros. Sorry, we should have more retros. More retros. Yeah. Like during the sprint or Yes. Do you know when the last time we had a retro was?

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Method Junction: Um the modal one. Yeah. September. Yeah. I had so much feedback that I wanted to share. I don't remember based on the modal one. No, based on this sprint. Oh, so you're saying I had a terrible time on this, right? Okay. Um, curious, uh, why

did you not feel like you wanted to share or do you did you not feel like you could share your feedback? No, I couldn't. Why? How was I supposed to share? We don't communicate the slot when you guys were all talking like I have to come back and ask you what decisions were made. Okay. Um, did you feel like the weekly check-ins were? I was told I wasn't needed at the weekly checks. Who said that? I don't think he said not needed. I swear he said um you're welcome to come. But it's it was more so for the developers to share. Yes. So if you guys are only talking about developers like what reason am I there?

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Method Junction: Yeah. Yeah. But uh what I'm saying is if you had something you wanted to share. I had so many things and there was no time. Like I we could have made time, right? That's all I'm saying. Like I'm I'm sorry that you didn't there was no space for you to communicate it. But I think it's important that you share that with us so then we would know we could have those times to actually talk about it. Right. But now now I'm aware and we can have um depending on the sprint's like two months. So maybe bi-weekly sprint I don't even know that might be too much. retros or bi-weekly is actually the minimum considered at the company here really. Okay. We can we can we can do bi spin retros then if there is feedback that needs to be shared we can do that then also we do plan to have uh weekly check-ins if we want to kind of dedicate some time to writing that down and then bringing up bringing it up into the retro so that they they wouldn't have to wait two weeks.

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Method Junction: Yeah. Right. So every week if uh they think something and they want to write it down every week then it would be helpful as well. Yeah. If that works I think moving forward would it help raise. Yeah we we I think we also just in general have too many fine agendas and like to have those talking points would be extremely useful. If it's not on the agenda, we shouldn't be talking about it in that meeting. Also, agenda oriented meetings. That's something action item agenda oriented. Which, sorry, I'm confused. Which meetings that were that we were in structured? Well, like I'm generally my Okay. There goes f****** And then I think the check-in meetings too. Um obviously I don't want you to feel like you shouldn't be there. So it's open to you as well and Barbara

too if she wants to be there. Um so open I guess making open is making it required everyone just so everyone's up to date.

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Method Junction: The thing is okay so initially I think it was because Barbara and uh so Barbra is a shared resource required then yeah I think um yeah yeah I think the I I think the main goal of the weekly check-in meetings was for developers to communicate their uh the block errors progress EPC right so I think we're yeah like should shouldn't be just developers right also Let me just close. Yeah. Yeah. So open it. We can have QA for sure as required. Personally, I think there was too much emphasis on meeting the demo after when I think it is more important like I mean this has been discussed but having the demo so that everybody knows what we're looking working on what it looks like. Like that's why like that does relate to everyone and that's why everybody should be there. I'm not saying that we shouldn't talk about the demo at all. Yeah. But it like was an overwhelming amount of like as a 15-minute check-in. It took more than 10 minutes just to settle on whether or not we're meeting the deadline.

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Method Junction: Also, none of our um meetings have strict agendas. They some of them have vague descriptions in what we're reviewing, but they're not structured as in we're not talking about how much time you're specific specifically spending on certain sections and when we should move on because a lot of the time our meetings also run over. The inventory discussion itself has no description at all. Which one? Sorry. The inventory discussion is called inventory discussion. Yeah, this I don't know if that was an ad hoc meeting or Okay, that's that's good feedback.
Fareen Khan: Uh quick um quick thing would it be helpful to have um more frequent I don't know decision or changes like a meeting where we discuss if there's any changes being made cuz I I understand Grace's pain point because there were so many changes and then those changes weren't documented which made pro made testing like a pain in the Yes.
Method Junction: I think we can use the grooming meeting for that to go over those changes. So as I understand it's not just about the frequency, it's more about structuring as well.

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Method Junction: So kind of setting out if it's smaller meeting than smaller meeting. Yes. But we defined structured meeting. Mhm. That is something that could probably help because there are two problems that we're dealing with, right? one is documentation and um the update of our communication all together and the second one is really structured uh meeting. So having not just the frequency but structured meeting. Yeah. Yeah. Of course. And also one thing that about about uh meeting deadlines. Yeah. That it's been always emphasized a lot. I don't know why but yeah quality should be always the higher priority. Uh yeah. But like was meeting deadlines like was that something that um it was uh emphasized that we we have to meet this deadline or was it more so are we on track to meeting this deadline? I felt in the check-ins that it was more like the discussion was oriented towards how do we justify the expectation that we're not meeting the deadline which like I guess you can talk about but like again if it's taking twoird of the check-in I I don't think it should be taking that long.

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Method Junction: Okay. How do they how do they tackle this on no code better like how do they usually tackle this because they no code has a different approach though because um the December 10th like live go live deadline is like it's set in stone it's just what features will be there and what features won't be there when we do go live that's the problem like it's just different like we don't know that date at all ever except for like you know if there's like a humongous the designer breaks when you load a right like P 0 issue if there are no P zeros it's going to go live no matter what I think um I I can say that from the justification of the deadlines I think um maybe there was uh more percentage of the time uh related to that just because um I think for the past year leadership is looking at our team thinking that we're missing deadlines honestly that that's that's what they okay that's fine we talk about it in standup and then you talk about it during the check-in again.

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Method Junction: Standups we barely talk about it like we it's like it's barely even touched. It's like we're we're missing it. Okay, we'll talk more in stand up or in check in. Okay. Um but no, I see your point of view. I'm just trying to play the devil's advocate that um that justification I think is needed just so we can share that what the why we're missing our deadline so that they understand but spending majority of the check-in on that definitely is not valid and uh we we'll keep it structured and time boxed. Um but yeah I feel like I think some of the discussions even in the checkin as to why it's based off of a memory again could be very easy was it's like our conversations would go like oh why why is the dead why is people you know like do you know why and then I guess you notice like I maybe it's just me but I don't remember talking that much about deadlines and checking meetings but no because check meetings some of like towards the start of the sprint we had migration going on right?

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Method Junction: Yeah. And then we got hit with the queue, I guess. Was that with migations? There was a queue. Yes. But then again, like it just there was a queue wait for one more to talk about. Yeah. And I don't know what happened. There was like one more conversation we had about it and that kind of got lost in somewhere. I don't know what it's one of the many emails we have and there was like specific reasons or something. Then I think then the migration went out. Then we had a bunch of the blog sesshares and that wasn't brought up. I think worked on it. Thank you for that. But it also wasn't brought up for too long as well. I guess it's what it is. Okay. So overall I don't think yeah this is a good point. We shouldn't be focusing as much on meeting the deadline. I know and from management perspective I know that they've been seeing our team as not hitting the deadline but we cannot be penalized right now just because our team was not hitting the deadline.

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Method Junction: Yeah. Yeah. No, no, but I think that's like caveat there is why are we not hitting it and that's that's the important part for leadership. It's not because it's our team that we're failing our performance with developing time or getting to done dev. is

literally out of our control. And I think that's more more than enough information for them to understand like we're actually we're actually performing. It's just the deployment process is swap. What I'm what I'm trying to say is this does not reflect on history either. Right now the things were out of our hand. Yeah. Maybe in the next trend it will be on in our hands and then we might miss or might not miss our deadline. But when it comes to a historical perspective, it's still not justifying why we were not hitting it before. I can only say why we are hitting or why we won't hit after I joined the team. Right. So it's like that's how I I look at it from my perspective.

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Method Junction: Yeah. So I don't think historical perspective could help in this particular scenario. Yeah. It probably doesn't. I'm just saying Ben and every and leadership there is a perception and it all we can do is um deliver good quality work which is what we're doing and if it does translate to hitting our deadlines it's a benefit but um that's just the deal. Yeah. I was going to say I don't think um we as a team get to justify that to management either like we don't have any direct like I don't have contact to Richard back personally I talked to John about it but um to him to John it's out of his hands like talking about like deadlines and what we should be focusing on mainly because if we have so many release issues shouldn't we be spending time to resolve those so that we can really smoothly when we do release new features because the migration service even though it was given to us as a ticket I didn't know we own migration service by the way you do not by the way no push back so oh is yeah yeah but um that ticket came in as a canban tech story um it was not like it was prioritized but it it was not prioritized to the degree of the sprint when it probably should have been just because it doesn't affect only our work but everybody else it's like how We built the model so that other teams can use the same component.

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Method Junction: So yeah, I would like to share that feedback to them but I don't have that app. Okay. Yeah, that is something that also was a thing. We did not own migration service and we had to fix that while we were trying to work on our sprint as well. Mhm. I think uh and was too midsprint. So it was like a very difficult position to kind of navigate. I know PR was still on boarding but at that same time PR had migration to update. So

which is a big thing every team uses. So probably having someone own migration would be one thing. Mhm. Yeah. That's probably something actionable but that's left up to the Yeah. up to us. Definitely bring those concerns up to them. Then it's up to them how they want to handle that. Um, anything else? Anything else? I I mean just more is like upper management feedback. Um, the reason why we have cues like migration Q stock apps Q is because everybody is pushing out new work at the same time.

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Method Junction: May maybe we shouldn't do that. or at least stagger like I'm not sure if at all the team should be on a sprint at the same time is basically what it is. Okay. So yeah from although from Yuri's perspective Yuri is kind of always stacked up with releases and yeah yeah so the thing is okay so from each and every team then there would have to be someone communicating to the release manager or other team's point of contact from with the release manager to confirm hey are you pushing it next or which screen are you pushing up and then kind of like a cross team communication would be something that we're looking at, right? And when it comes to was because when stock apps was their own team, that was something that they did within themselves. Yes, correct. At at this point now, we do not have a TL and usually the TL is the one that would communicate, right? Is what I am guessing. No, normally like anything that's going out that like I talk to about.

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Method Junction: So then QA would have to also communicate with other teams which would kind of thing right now like to ask like now yes Yuri is managing what the queue is. Um but before yeah like we did have to ask hey are you like releasing this app? How many apps are you releasing? How many screens are you releasing? It's something we did have to coordinate. Um okay so in that in that sense uh process wise do you think the QA itself would be the one that should communicate or do you think when someone from the strange should be the one communicating because um would that be helpful uh the dev communicating with fury or would be like the way our process works is right it goes to intest and then sorry it goes to dev and after DV it's like the QA responsibility in this context it's my responsibility I take it from D to all the way to needs to deploy right so at that point in time I I do think that it is more convenient for the QA to communicate

simply because all of the QAs are already in different teams so we all you know have a way to just talk to each other and they can talk to their teams and stuff it's convenient is it the right thing I'm not entirely certain I haven't been long enough to comment on that we just trying to alleviate the bottleneck or uh the pressure that a QA would put into right because at the same time they have to

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Method Junction: test at the same time they will have to uh uh to sync up with other QAs and at the same time speak to the release manager. Yeah. So it's going to be a little I think the issue is not the communication the issue is how soon in advance do we need to start the communication outside of our team. Um because it's easy to say like uh I like since that when I started testing I knew how many screens there were like well for me can only work on so many screens they won't give me new ones without telling me right but I cannot confidently say that I will be done testing these screens by X date mostly because if I send them for defects I can't estimate that. Um, so I think we need to decide how like Yeah. How soon in advance like can we go like as a team tell you this is what we plan to release but not really know how far in advance to release it. Yeah. Because by the time it is ready to release there already exists this queue and like another gripe with the queue is that all of the current stock apps releases are like for sprint things.

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Method Junction: If we wanted to fix a P2 bug it can't go out right now. Yeah. which is happening for the purchase order ticket, right? It's still kind of Yeah, because that's lower lower priority than everybody else's sprint. So, yeah, that's kind of a point right now. Anything else anyone wants to bring up for him? We will of course go through this these action items again. Yeah, I'm going to create a doc and post on compost and share with the team and we can but I'll start immediately with the decision blog stuff because we can action on that. At least I can action on that right away and then um also to set up bi-weekly sprint retro meetings um weekly check-in meetings and ensure that all meetings are structured in time box as well. Okay. I know what you're saying for the if we if for's idea to discuss decisions as a meeting, I don't think it should be our weekly group, but that's more because like I I could see it differently, but because the resources

are split where one dev is on canband and two devs are on the sprint, I think we should keep the canban and the sprint like meetings separate because the grooming should be for canban tickets, right?

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Method Junction: Yeah. No, I I was saying it it the trend right now is we don't have anything to. So that's a little bit different though. But if there is something to think. Yeah, exactly. Yeah, it'll be two different things. But yeah, I'll find time that works that we can have those. Um there'll probably be I could put an actual time box for decision meetings. Um and then you want that or we can have it ad hoc and I we just create it but we have everything documented. the the situation with ADH is if you come across a decision or some kind of switch not like right away but like based on like okay we'll keep it we'll keep it uh weekly then uh I'll create like 30 minute decision model easier. Okay, I think that's everything. We're over time. Uh thanks everyone. Thanks K. Thanks Barbara. Thank you. Bye guys. Bye guys. I checked on a beta account that happens. Huh? You check on another beta? Yeah, I checked on um Ash's beta. You get shot every time.

Transcription ended after 01:09:44

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